Results Section Peer Review: Instructions for Reviewers and Authors

Foundations of Clinical Research · Level 1: From Clinical Question to Publication

Organisation: Neudata (*#ClearDataClearImpact*)

When: the 2 weeks after Session 8 (individual homework)

Who reviews whom: your reviewer is assigned at random and announced in Session 7. Everyone reviews one draft and receives one review.

Use with: `Manuscript_Brief.pdf`, the results pack for the author's question, and `Response_to_Reviewers_Template.docx`

1. Timeline

When	Who	What
Session 7 (12 December)	Course lead	Announces who reviews whom, and sends the list by email
23:59, 19 December 2026 (day of Session 8)	Author	Emails the Results draft directly to the reviewer and to the course lead
2 January 2027 (2 weeks after Session 8)	Reviewer	Emails the review report (`Surname_Firstname_Review.docx`) to the author and to the course lead
30 January 2027 (4 weeks after the review)	Author	Emails the revised Results section (tracked changes) and the response letter to the course lead

If your draft has not arrived by the morning after Session 8, email the author and the course lead. Plan about 1.5 hours for the review.

2. How to review (reviewer)

1. Read the draft once without commenting. Write in one sentence what it found.
2. Open the results pack for the author's question and check every number in the text and tables.
3. Answer the Results checklist below (Yes / No, with page or line).
4. Sort your comments into **major** (would change the numbers or the reader's trust) and **minor** (wording, formatting). About 2 to 4 major and 3 to 8 minor.
5. If the author sent optional parts (Methods, Introduction, Discussion, Abstract), add one or two comments on each.

Results checklist

#	Check	Yes / No	Page / line
1	The working title names population, exposure, outcome and design, with "associated"		
2	Participants first: numbers enrolled, analysed and excluded, with reasons		
3	Table 1 summarised in one or two sentences, with numbers. Missing data reported		
4	Outcome numbers per group, with denominators		
5	Main result: crude and adjusted estimates with 95% CI		
6	Other analyses from the pack reported (sensitivity, imputation or subgroup)		
7	Every number agrees with the results pack		
8	Tables and figure stand alone (title, units, n, abbreviations)		
9	No interpretation and no causal words ("because", "caused", "trend")		
10	Simulated-data and AI-use statements present		

3. Tone rules

1. Comment on the text, not the person: "The Results do not report the crude OR", not "You forgot...".
2. Be specific: page, line, the problem and a suggestion.
3. Start with two genuine strengths.
4. Stay within the data. Do not ask for analyses that are not in the pack.
5. Keep it confidential. Do not share the draft and do **not** paste it into an AI tool.

4. Review report template

Copy this into `Surname_Firstname_Review.docx`.

Draft reviewed: author _____, Question Q___, working title: _____

Reviewer: _____ **Date:** _____

1. Summary (2 or 3 sentences): what the Results show, in your own words.

2. Strengths (2 points).

3. Major comments (each with page/line, the problem and a suggestion).

- M1.
- M2.

4. Minor comments.

- m1.

- m2.

5. Results checklist: attach the completed table from section 2.

6. Optional parts (if sent): one or two comments on each.

7. Recommendation (tick one): ☐ Accept as it is ☐ Minor revision ☐ Major revision

5. How authors respond (author)

1. Read the review, then wait a day before replying.
2. Use `Response_to_Reviewers_Template.docx`. Thank the reviewer in one sentence.
3. For every comment give: the comment (copied), your reply, and what you changed, with page and line.
4. Make the changes with tracked changes switched on.
5. You may disagree, politely and with reasons from the data.
6. Never answer just "Done".

Example

Reviewer comment	Response	Change in the Results
M1. Only the adjusted OR is given, so readers cannot see how much adjustment changed the estimate.	Thank you. We now report the crude OR next to the adjusted OR.	p. 2, lines 4 to 7, and Table 2

6. Marking

The review you give and your response are criteria 8 and 9 of Manuscript_Rubric.pdf (20 points).